

GLOBAL CATALYST CHALLENGE 2027

Official Rulebook and Applicant Handbook

FICTIONAL TEST DOCUMENT

Purpose: This 20-page rulebook was created solely to test ActionLayer document extraction, conflict detection, deadline parsing, conditional requirements, task generation, evidence logic, and readiness auditing.

Version	1.4 - fictional release
Published	15 September 2026
Primary application deadline	31 March 2027, 11:59 PM UTC
Organizer	Catalyst Learning Foundation
Program format	Online with optional showcase
Contact	challenge@example-catalyst.org

Critical warning

All organizations, links, names, rules, dates, prizes, and contacts in this document are fictional. Do not submit an application or send personal information.

1. Contents and Document Map

This page is intentionally structured to test whether an extraction system can locate requirements distributed across a long document.

1	Cover and control information
2	Contents and document map
3	Program purpose and definitions
4	Eligibility rules
5	Conditional eligibility and exceptions
6	Dates, deadlines, and timezone rules
7	Registration and account setup
8	Team formation and participation
9	Challenge tracks and selection
10	Proposal requirements
11	Prototype and technical requirements
12	Responsible AI and data rules
13	Required deliverables
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18	Disqualification, appeals, and conflicts
19	Final readiness checklist
20	Appendix: conflicts and unresolved information

Testing note

Important requirements intentionally appear outside their most obvious sections. ActionLayer should preserve source page references and should not rely only on headings.

2. Program Purpose and Definitions

The Global Catalyst Challenge 2027 supports student-led technology projects addressing education access, climate resilience, accessibility, public-interest digital infrastructure, or community wellbeing.

2.1 Program objectives

- Encourage practical prototypes tied to a documented community need.
- Improve responsible use of artificial intelligence and data.
- Support interdisciplinary student collaboration.
- Produce open, reproducible learning resources where legally possible.

2.2 Key definitions

Applicant	The individual who creates the application account and accepts the declaration.
Team member	A person listed on the final team roster before the roster lock date.
Submission	All files, links, declarations, and forms received through the official portal.
Required evidence	A file, URL, declaration, or organizer confirmation needed to mark a requirement complete.
Finalist	A team invited to the live online demonstration round.
Official source	This rulebook, a signed addendum, or a notice published in the official portal. Social posts are not official unless linked from the portal.

Interpretation rule	If a promotional poster conflicts with this rulebook, the rulebook controls unless the official portal contains a later signed addendum.
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3. Core Eligibility Rules

Eligibility is assessed at registration and again before awards are confirmed.

3.1 Individual eligibility

- Must be at least 18 years old on 5 July 2027.
- Must be currently enrolled in an undergraduate, postgraduate, vocational, or accredited bootcamp program on the final application date.
- Must be able to participate in English-language online sessions.
- Must not be an employee, contractor, judge, or immediate family member of a judge or organizer.
- Must submit truthful information and agree to source verification.

3.2 Geographic eligibility

Applications are welcomed from all countries except where local law, sanctions, export controls, or the payment provider prevent participation or receipt of an award. The organizer does not provide legal advice about local eligibility.

3.3 Academic status evidence

Acceptable initial evidence includes a current student card, enrollment letter, current transcript, or institutional portal screenshot. The organizer may request stronger evidence before awards are paid.

Human review required

The phrase “all countries” is subject to legal and payment restrictions. An AI system must not convert this into a guaranteed global eligibility claim.

4. Conditional Eligibility and Exceptions

Several rules apply only under particular circumstances. These conditions should become conditional tasks rather than universal requirements.

GPA below 3.20/4.00 or equivalent	Upload a one-page academic context statement and evidence of leadership or community impact.
Applicant already receives another scholarship	Submit a funding-disclosure statement naming the provider and any restrictions.
Applicant requests accessibility support	Submit an accommodation request. Medical evidence is not required at initial application.
Project involves minors	Provide a safeguarding plan before finalist confirmation.
Project collects personal data	Provide a privacy notice, consent process, retention period, and deletion method.
Project uses third-party datasets	Document license, provenance, and permitted use.
Applicant is graduating before program start	Provide evidence that the institution considers the applicant enrolled on 31 March 2027.

4.1 Exception requests

Exception requests must be submitted no later than 20 March 2027. An exception request does not extend the final application deadline and does not guarantee approval.

Dependency suggestion	Conditional documents should be generated only after the relevant personal condition is known.
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5. Dates, Deadlines, and Timezones

Applications open	1 February 2027, 09:00 UTC
Early feedback deadline	28 February 2027, 17:00 GMT
Exception request deadline	20 March 2027, 17:00 UTC
Main application deadline	31 March 2027, 23:59 UTC
Recommendation-letter deadline	3 April 2027, 17:00 UTC
Shortlist notice	20 April 2027
Interview window	1-10 May 2027
Final results	25 May 2027
Program begins	5 July 2027
Online showcase	18 December 2027, time to be announced

Known conflict

The application portal banner says “submit by 30 March 2027.” The organizer has not confirmed whether this is an error. Applicants should treat 30 March as the operational target while requesting clarification.

5.1 Timezone handling

UTC and GMT are written exactly as published. If an external poster omits a timezone, the application must mark the deadline as requiring review rather than assigning a timezone silently.

6. Registration and Account Setup

Applicants must create an account before starting the full application.

- Use an email address checked regularly through December 2027.
- Verify the email address within 48 hours.
- Use the applicant's legal or official institutional name.
- Enable multi-factor authentication if offered.
- Retain the application ID shown after account creation.

6.1 Account ownership

One person may create only one applicant account. Shared team email addresses are not accepted. The applicant account owner receives all legal notices and must certify the final submission.

6.2 Portal availability

The organizer does not guarantee uninterrupted portal access. Applicants should upload files early and retain local copies. A screenshot showing an attempted upload is not proof that a submission was received.

Evidence suggestion	Recommended evidence: verified-email confirmation, application ID, and screenshot of the application dashboard.
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7. Team Formation and Participation

The rulebook permits teams, but another source creates an intentional conflict for testing.

7.1 Team size

- Teams may contain 1 to 4 eligible members.
- One member must be designated Team Lead.
- Each person may join only one team.
- Team changes are allowed until 10 April 2027 at 17:00 UTC.
- A finalist team must retain at least one original member.

7.2 Conflict with application instructions

The online application instructions currently state: “Only individual applications are accepted.” This conflicts with the team rule above. The organizer has not yet issued a signed clarification.

7.3 Team responsibilities

- Team Lead certifies accuracy and submits the final application.
- Every member must approve the ethics and data declaration.
- Awards are paid to the Team Lead unless the organizer approves another arrangement.
- The team is responsible for internal distribution of funds.

Conflict status	ActionLayer should mark team participation as conflicting, not confirmed, and should create a clarification task before team-dependent work begins.
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8. Challenge Tracks and Track Selection

Education Access	Learning access, teacher support, inclusion	Demonstrate a real user need and measurable learning benefit.
Climate Resilience	Preparedness, resource efficiency, local adaptation	Explain environmental trade-offs and implementation context.
Accessibility	Independent living, communication, inclusive design	Include accessible testing or review by intended users where feasible.
Community Infrastructure	Public-interest services, civic tools, local coordination	Address safety, governance, and maintenance responsibility.
Open Innovation	Projects outside listed tracks	Explain why the project does not fit another track.

8.1 Track choice

Select one primary track at submission. A secondary track may be listed, but judging occurs under the primary track. Track changes are not permitted after the final deadline.

Missing information	The number of finalists per track has not been announced.
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9. Project Proposal Requirements

The project proposal is a core submission document and must be uploaded as one PDF.

9.1 Required sections

- Title and one-sentence summary
- Problem statement
- Target users or community
- Evidence of need
- Proposed solution
- Implementation plan
- Six-month timeline
- Estimated budget
- Risk analysis
- Ethical considerations
- Data and privacy approach
- Sustainability and maintenance plan
- Expected outcomes and evaluation method

9.2 Format

- Maximum 6 pages excluding title page and references.
- A4 or US Letter accepted.
- Minimum 10-point body text.
- PDF only.
- Maximum file size 8 MB.
- Applicant and team names must not appear in the proposal body because proposals are reviewed anonymously.

9.3 External links

Reviewers are not required to open external links. Essential information must appear in the proposal itself.

Hidden restriction

The anonymity rule appears only in this section and should generate a high-priority validation task.

10. Prototype and Technical Requirements

10.1 Minimum prototype

The prototype must demonstrate the core user journey. A design mockup alone is not sufficient unless the project is in the policy or research category and the track chair grants written approval.

10.2 Repository

- A source-code repository is required for software projects.
- The repository may be private during initial review.
- Finalists must provide organizer access within 48 hours of request.
- The README must include setup instructions, license information, known limitations, and test instructions.
- Secrets, access tokens, private datasets, and personal information must not be committed.

10.3 Demonstration environment

- The demo must not rely on prohibited data or unauthorized accounts.
- Any paid API dependency must include a fallback demonstration path.
- If internet access is required, the team must also provide a short recorded fallback.
- Projects must not execute untrusted user code without isolation.

Operational dependency	Repository creation should unlock prototype development and documentation tasks, but not automatically mark them complete.
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11. Responsible AI, Data, and Safety Rules

11.1 AI use

- AI-assisted coding, brainstorming, translation, and editing are allowed.
- Substantial AI-generated content must be disclosed.
- Fabricated references, results, user interviews, metrics, or impact claims are prohibited.
- Teams remain responsible for correctness, safety, privacy, and compliance.
- Projects using generative AI must document model, purpose, limitations, and user safeguards.

11.2 Data protection

- Collect only necessary data.
- Explain consent and withdrawal.
- Define retention and deletion.
- Do not upload sensitive personal data to third-party AI services without lawful basis and explicit disclosure.
- Do not use confidential, stolen, or improperly licensed datasets.

11.3 Prohibited use

- Malware, credential theft, harassment, deceptive impersonation, unlawful surveillance, discriminatory exclusion, or dangerous instructions.
- Attempts to manipulate judges, voting, or platform analytics.
- False claims that an AI assessment is official certification.

Evidence requirement	AI projects must attach an AI-use disclosure and a short risk-and-limitation statement.
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12. Required Deliverables

Application form	Portal fields	All required fields	Submission receipt
Project proposal	PDF	6 pages + title/references	File opens; anonymity check
Prototype	Working demo	Core journey	Screenshots or test record
Repository	URL	Accessible to organizer	README and license present
Demo video	Unlisted URL	Maximum 2 minutes	Link works without permission request
Project summary	Plain text	Maximum 400 words	Portal preview
Budget	Spreadsheet or portal table	USD values	Totals match request
AI-use disclosure	PDF or portal text	Maximum 1 page	Models and limitations stated
Team declaration	Portal checkbox	All members	Approvals recorded

Conflict

A promotional poster says the demo video may be 3 minutes. This rulebook sets a 2-minute maximum. Treat the shorter official limit as controlling unless a later signed addendum changes it.

13. Evidence and File-Format Rules

13.1 File naming

Use the pattern APPLICATIONID_DELIVERABLE_VERSION.ext. Example:
GC271843_PROPOSAL_V2.pdf.

13.2 Accepted formats

Proposal	PDF	8 MB
Resume or member profile	PDF	3 MB
Transcript or enrollment proof	PDF, JPEG, PNG	5 MB
Budget	XLSX, CSV, portal table	5 MB
Evidence image	JPEG, PNG, WebP	10 MB
Demo video	Unlisted streaming link	No direct upload
Repository	GitHub, GitLab, or equivalent URL	Access required

13.3 Link rules

- Links requiring access requests are not accepted.
- Publicly editable links are not accepted.
- URL shorteners are discouraged.
- The applicant must retest every link before final submission.

Verification limitation

A reachable link does not prove that its content satisfies the requirement. Link accessibility and content assessment should remain separate checks.

14. Submission Portal Procedure

14.1 Required order

1	Create and verify account	Verified-email notice
2	Complete applicant and team details	Profile status shows complete
3	Select primary track	Track confirmation
4	Upload proposal and supporting files	Per-file success indicator
5	Add repository and video links	Links pass access check
6	Complete declarations	All required approvals recorded
7	Preview submission	No unresolved required field
8	Submit application	Receipt with timestamp and application ID

14.2 Changes after submission

Applicants may edit and resubmit before the portal closes. Each resubmission replaces the previous portal version, but the organizer may retain audit records.

14.3 Confirmation

A saved draft is not a submitted application. Only the final receipt confirms submission.

Final dependency	The “Submit application” task must depend on all required deliverables and declaration tasks, not merely on file upload.
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15. Judging and Scoring

Problem importance	15%	Evidence of need and relevance to intended users
Solution quality	20%	Clarity, appropriateness, and technical or operational design
Feasibility	15%	Resources, timeline, dependencies, and implementation realism
Demonstrated progress	15%	Working prototype and evidence of testing
Expected impact	15%	Plausible benefit and evaluation approach
Responsible design	10%	Safety, accessibility, privacy, fairness, and ethics
Communication	5%	Clarity of proposal and demonstration
Sustainability	5%	Maintenance, ownership, and long-term viability

15.1 Tie-break order

Ties are resolved by higher Responsible Design score, then Feasibility, then Problem Importance. If still tied, the judging chair records a documented decision.

15.2 Public voting

Public voting may be offered as a separate recognition and does not alter the core judging score.

Missing information

Judge names and the number of judging panels have not been published.

16. Awards and Funding Restrictions

Grand Award	USD 10,000	Subject to onboarding, legal eligibility, and approved budget.
Track Awards	USD 3,000 each	One per track if an entry meets the standard.
Responsible Design Award	USD 2,000	May be combined with a track award.
Community Choice	Non-cash recognition	Based on separate public voting rules.
Finalist Support	Up to USD 300	Reimbursement basis; receipts required.

16.1 Permitted uses

- Prototype development
- Approved software or cloud costs
- User testing and accessibility support
- Necessary equipment
- Community engagement
- Project documentation

16.2 Prohibited uses

- Personal salary unless explicitly approved
- Luxury equipment
- Political campaigning
- Cryptocurrency purchases
- Illegal activity
- Unrelated travel
- Debt repayment

No guarantee

Selection does not guarantee the maximum award. Final funding depends on budget review, legal eligibility, and available funds.

17. Disqualification, Appeals, and Conflicts

17.1 Grounds for disqualification

- False or misleading information
- Plagiarism or unauthorized use of work
- Fabricated references, results, users, or impact claims
- Violation of data, safety, or participation rules
- Failure to disclose a material conflict of interest
- Harassment or interference with other participants
- Submission after the confirmed deadline
- Failure to provide requested eligibility evidence

17.2 Appeals

Procedural appeals must be submitted within five calendar days of the relevant decision. Appeals must identify the specific rule or process allegedly applied incorrectly. Disagreement with a judge's scoring judgment is not, by itself, a procedural appeal.

17.3 Organizer conflict

A judge with a personal, financial, supervisory, or recent collaboration relationship with an applicant must disclose the conflict and recuse from scoring that entry.

Unresolved process	The organizer has not published the appeal form or the email address for procedural appeals.
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18. Final Readiness Checklist

This checklist is intended to test ActionLayer’s readiness audit and evidence mapping.

Eligibility	Age, enrollment, geography, conflicts, team status confirmed
Deadlines	Main deadline and recommendation conflict reviewed
Account	Email verified and application ID retained
Proposal	Complete, within page limit, anonymous, PDF opens
Prototype	Core journey works and fallback exists
Repository	Accessible, README complete, no secrets
Video	Unlisted, accessible, no more than 2 minutes
Evidence	Required evidence attached and prior checks preserved
AI disclosure	Models, uses, safeguards, and limitations documented
Links	All links open without access request
Declarations	Every required member approval recorded
Final receipt	Submission receipt saved after final submit

Recommended next action rule	If a deadline conflict remains unresolved, deadline clarification should outrank drafting or optional work because it affects the entire schedule.
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19. Appendix: Conflict and Missing-Information Register

The following items are intentionally unresolved. A reliable system should expose them rather than inventing answers.

C-01	Portal says 30 March; rulebook says 31 March 2027	conflicting - human review required
C-02	Team size 1-4; application instructions say individual only	conflicting - clarification task
C-03	Recommendation due 3 April; FAQ says 31 March	conflicting - operational risk
C-04	Poster allows 3-minute video; rulebook allows 2 minutes	use stricter official limit; retain conflict note
M-01	Interview times not announced	missing
M-02	Showcase location not announced	missing
M-03	Travel policy not announced	missing
M-04	Number of finalists not announced	missing
M-05	Appeal form and address not published	missing
Q-01	All-country eligibility subject to legal restrictions	needs review; no guarantee
Q-02	Funding maximum subject to budget and legal checks	conditional
Q-03	Timezone absent on promotional materials	requires timezone review

Expected final audit

A correct readiness audit should not report full readiness while C-01, C-02, or required deliverable evidence remains unresolved.

End of fictional rulebook

Use this document only for controlled ActionLayer testing. Do not submit real personal data with it.